

Reading & Writing for Academic Purposes (A): Research Paper Reading & Writing

Instructor: 庞红梅

Academic Year: Fall 2024

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Venue: 6B104

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Class Periods: 22, 23

Office Hour: Tue. 15: 15-16: 15, 6B104, by appointment

TA: 宫凯璇, 15822498522, Office hour: Wed. 10: 00-11: 00, by appointment

Course Description:

Reading & Writing for Academic Purposes (A) is designed to develop students' critical thinking and academic reading and writing competencies. There is strong emphasis on the production of a research paper using a **mini-project-based approach**. The course will prepare students for the research genre which is required in various academic fields. The experimental research article follows the four-part **IMRD** format (Introduction, Method, Results, and Discussion). The project involves limited original research that provides the vehicle for developing the necessary writing skills. Using an idealized format for the genre allows students to address writing issues through authentic tasks without the barrier of field-specific content. It also allows students to use the general framework of the research article to become aware of discipline-specific deviations.

One word of caution: please note that this course is not designed to teach you how to write fast, painless academic papers for your other courses, although some students say this approach has helped them. Instead, this course should help you learn more about how to use research to suit your own personal needs.

Required Textbook: 庞红梅, 《学术英语研究论文阅读与写作》, 清华大学出版社, 2024

Course Objectives: Upon completion of the Course, students will be able to:

- Demonstrate ability to evaluate and critique research articles in various fields.
- Apply critical thinking to academic writing, with an emphasis on the specific genre of experimental research article.
- Demonstrate ability to define a research question, develop a data collection instrument and write research articles that follow the four-part IMRD format.
- Be aware of cultural differences in academic reading and writing.
- Reconvene written materials to oral presentation.
- Employ correct citation style, including parenthetical, in-text citation and works-cited pages.

Working languages:

Both English and Chinese will be used in this class to facilitate your understanding.

Course Assessment:

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|--|-----|
| ➤ Class participation | 10% |
| ➤ Oral presentation | 15% |
| ➤ 5 Writing assignments (process assessment) | 50% |

	✓	I+M (see class calendar for due dates)	
	✓	R+D (see class calendar for due dates)	
	✓	Abstract (see class calendar for due dates)	
➤ Final paper		(product assessment)	25%
	✓	Title page	
	✓	Abstract (see class calendar for due dates)	
	✓	IMRD	
	✓	Reference	

Course Requirements:

1. Participation and punctuality: While attendance is obviously required for participation, it by itself is not sufficient; rather, participation will be defined as full involvement in all class activities, including discussion, group work, workshops, peer response, conferences, etc. Failure to participate will, at times, adversely affect both your participation grade and your grade for particular assignments.
2. There will be 5 short writing assignments: **Introduction, Methods, Results, Discussion and Abstract**. You are expected to complete these assignments on time and be prepared to respond to questions about them in writing and orally. **(process assessment)**
3. In addition to 5 short writing assignments, there will be a **research paper**. The research paper should be about 3000 words. **(product assessment)**
4. **All papers must be typed, double-spaced and follow the APA documentation style.** <https://apastyle.apa.org/>
5. Students are divided into groups of four. You are encouraged to work together on defining research questions, developing data collection instrument, and collecting data. But each individual student has to write **your own Introduction, Results and Discussion** part (you can have a **group Methods** part).
6. After you have finished the final version of the paper, the group will make a **timed** formal presentation of your study. This will help you clarify what you have learned and lead to a better paper. It will also help you better understand the difference between written papers and oral presentations.

Presentation assessment criteria:

- **Content (15%)**: task fulfillment (including timing); showing thorough research, use of authoritative and up-to-date sources.
- **Language (20%)**: accuracy and range of sentence structures; spoken academic style; appropriacy of vocabulary; meaning communicated effectively and appropriately through language choices
- **Delivery (35%)**: clear and concise presentation; ideas presented logically with effective transitions; effective strategies to engage the audience; listening and answering skills; support of co-presenter; voice projection; body language; use of visual aids; integration of citations
- **Pronunciation and fluency (30%)**: effective communication of meaning through pronunciation; fluency of speech.

Preparation:

Prior to each class you are expected to read and reflect upon all of the assignments. **Note: coming to class unprepared is just like not coming at all.**

Plagiarism:

1. Plagiarism (sariqa = theft) is immoral and illegal.
2. THU takes a very serious view against dishonesty and plagiarism in students' work. Any student who violates academic integrity will receive an F for the course.
3. Guidelines for Students on the Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence:
 - While taking an open and forward-looking stance on the use of generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) tools (such as ChatGPT) as a positive and creative force in education, and the incorporation of such use in innovative learning, teaching, and assessment practices, this course upholds the principle that students must adhere to high standards of academic integrity in all forms of assessments.
 - Do NOT rely solely on AI-generated content as the source of information.
 - Do NOT ask GenAI software to write your paper. All the work you submit for assessment should be **YOUR OWN ORIGINAL** work. Asking GenAI to do the assignment for you and submitting the work generated by GenAI, in part or in whole, as your own (even in paraphrased form) constitute an act of academic dishonesty; it is no different from asking another person to write your assignment or claiming others' ideas as your own.
 - Use GenAI wisely, ethically and critically. You may use GenAI for brainstorming and use AI-generated content in conjunction with other sources to ensure your work is reliable and well informed.

Late Papers:

1. It is your responsibility to turn in your assignments in person and on time.
2. Late submission, although accepted within 3 calendar days after the deadline, are subject to the following downgrading penalties:
 - a deduction of 10% of the marks if the assignment is submitted within 24 hours after the deadline
 - a deduction of 20% of the marks if the assignment is submitted within 48 hours after the deadline
 - a deduction of 30% of the marks if the assignment is submitted within 72 hours after the deadline
3. If you do not submit your assignment within 72 hours, then you will be considered to **have not taken the assessment and will fail the subject.**
4. If you believe that you have a valid reason for a late submission, such as you are suffering from an illness, you will not receive a penalty provided that sufficient documentary evidence is provided within 7 calendar days of the assignment submission deadline.

Classroom policy: Mobile phones should be switched off and kept out of sight during class period. Laptops are **NOT** permitted in this class unless told otherwise.

Miscellaneous:

1. 本课程所有课件, 包括 syllabus, lecture ppt, handout 等仅供本课程内部交流, 请勿外传!
2. 请勿多次提交作业!
3. 请记住助教的信息, 欢迎与助教沟通!
4. 本课程评估以综合评定的形式, 请慎重选择!!!
5. 微信群是课程重要的沟通工具, 请大家实名加入课程微信群。微信群仅供英语学习和课程讨论, 请勿发布不相关内容, 请勿将群内消息截图、转发。

Class Calendar:

Week	Date	In-Class Activities	Your HW Schedule
1	9/10	Orientation: Introduction of the course	Read unit 1.
2	9/17	Holiday~~~~~	
3	9/24	Unit 1: Overview of a research paper. Set up small groups and select topics	Read unit 2.
4	9/29 (日)	Unit 2: Introduction	Read unit 3.
5	10/8	Unit 3: Literature review	Begin your research.
6	10/15	Guest lecture: Information literacy	Continue with your research.
7	10/22	Small Group Conference	Read unit 4. Continue with your research.
8	10/29	Unit 4: Methods	Read unit 5. Continue with your research.
9	11/5	Unit 5: Results and Discussion (I) Due: Introduction and Methods	Continue with your research. Read unit 6.
10	11/12	Comment +Review (I)	Continue with your research.
11	11/19	Unit 6: Results and Discussion (II)	Read unit 7. Continue with your research.
12	11/26	Unit 7: Abstract+Title	Read unit 8. Continue with your research.
13	12/3	Unit 8: References+Acknowledgements Email writing Due: Results and Discussion	Continue with your research.
14	12/10	Making presentations Comment +Review (II)	Prepare for group oral presentation.
15	12/17	Group Oral Presentations (I)	Revise, edit, and proofread your draft.
16	12/24	Group Oral Presentations (II) Due: Final Paper and Abstract	

Note:

1. The course syllabus provides a general plan for the course; deviations may be necessary.
2. Remember to refer to the syllabus throughout the semester.
3. Any comments, suggestions, and complaints are welcomed and appreciated. Feel free to

contact me.

4. Stay flexible; Stay positive.

Resources:

英英词典

<https://dictionary.cambridge.org/>

<https://www.collinsdictionary.com/dictionary/english/>

<https://www.merriam-webster.com/>

<https://thesaurus.plus/> English thesaurus dictionary 同义词词典

<http://ozdic.com/> The English collocation dictionary 搭配词典

学术词汇、搭配与句式

<http://www.newacademicwordlist.org/> Academic word list (AWL)

<http://www.englishvocabularyexercises.com/AWL/index.htm#what> AWL exercises

<https://www.smart-words.org/>

<http://skell.sketchengine.co.uk/> SKELL Engine for collocations

<http://www.just-the-word.com/>

<https://linggle.com/>

<http://www.phrasebank.manchester.ac.uk/> Academic phrasebank

论文写作格式

<http://www.lib.tsinghua.edu.cn/service/paperwriting.html> 清华大学图书馆

<http://www.apastyle.org/> American Psychological Association Guidelines

<https://writing.wisc.edu/handbook/documentation/> University of Wisconsin-Madison

写作及朗读软件

<https://www.grammarly.com/> A downloadable AI-powered writing assistant

<http://writeaway.nlpweb.org/> An online writing tool that completes words to help highlight typical structures

<https://www.naturalreaders.com/software.html/> AI Text to Speech

国外大学写作资源

<http://owl.english.purdue.edu/> Purdue Online Writing lab

<https://writing.wisc.edu/> The Writing Center, University of Wisconsin-Madison

<https://cgi.duke.edu/web/sciwriting/index.php/> Duke University Scientific Writing Resource

其他

<https://edubirdie.com/blog/100-research-paper-topics/> Top 200+ ideas for research paper topics

<https://www.bartleby.com/141/> The elements of style by William Strunk

<https://www.ted.com/#/> Ted talks

<https://www.icourse163.org/search.htm?search=%E5%AD%A6%E6%9C%AF%E8%8B%B1%E8%AF%AD#/> 中国大学 MOOC 学术英语课程

<http://mooc1.chaoxing.com/course/90257553.html> 《国际学术论文写作与发表》MOOC

<https://www.nobelprize.org/> The official website of the Nobel Prize